GDAI 2026 Conference Agenda

Global Data & AI Virtual Tech Conference

DATES	DAILY HOURS	TIME ZONE
20–22 November 2026	**9:00 AM – 6:00 PM CST**	**Central Standard Time (UTC−6)**

Postponed from 22–24 August 2026. Sessions may run concurrently across multiple tracks. Additional speaker details and sessions may be updated before the agenda is finalized.

Day 1 — Friday, 20 November 2026

9:00 AM – 6:00 PM CST

TIME (CST)	TYPE	SESSION	SPEAKER
9:00 – 9:15 AM	Plenary	**Welcome & Opening Announcements**	
9:15 – 9:45 AM	Plenary	**Opening Keynote Address**	
9:45 – 10:15 AM	Concurrent 1	AI, Ambient Intelligence, and the Future of Senior Living	Mark Francis
	Concurrent 2	Before the Bot: How AI-Driven Business Infrastructure Creates Fundable, Scalable Enterprises	Algernae King
	Concurrent 3	When AI Enters Matters: A Behavioral Case for Human-First Reasoning	Devika Toprani
	Concurrent 4	AI-Augmented Query Optimization: SQL Server 2025 Meets Fabric Self-Healing Data Platform	Shankar Narayanan SGS
10:15 – 10:45 AM	Concurrent 1	Beyond Single Agents: Multi-Agent AI in Software Testing	Him Raj Singh
	Concurrent 2	Designing AI Experiences Customers Actually Trust	Ajitha Koduri
	Concurrent 3	Teaching Spark to Tune Itself: Reinforcement Learning for Smarter Optimization	Hina Gandhi
	Concurrent 4	Designing Low-Latency Online Data Stores for AI-Driven Financial Services	Santhosh Anchoori
10:45 – 11:15 AM	Concurrent 1	Beyond the Slot-Filler: Architecting Reasoning Loops for Agentic Assistants	Akhil Sharma
	Concurrent 2	Auditable AI Agents for Enterprise Finance	Siddharth Jain
	Concurrent 3	Responsible Healthcare AI: Governance, Explainability, and Patient Safety	Tarina Samanta
	Concurrent 4	Humanizing AI Strategy	Tiankai Feng

TIME (CST)	TYPE	SESSION	SPEAKER
11:15 – 11:45 AM	Concurrent 1	Beyond the Prototype: Building Resilient, Non-Hallucinating AI Agents at Scale	Susmita Singh
	Concurrent 2	From Assistant to Operator: Security and Governance Risks in Multi-Agent AI Workflows	Gbenga Akingbulere
	Concurrent 3	Assembling Your A-Team: Hiring the Right Talent in the Age of AI	Kolby Goodman
	Concurrent 4	AI Driven Enterprise Data Modernization Using Semantic Intelligence and Cloud AI Platforms	Hirenkumar Dholariya
11:45 AM – 12:15 PM	Plenary	**Virtual Networking / Coffee Break**	
12:15 – 12:45 PM	Concurrent 1	Letting Data Dream: Unlock Possibilities	Queen Smith
	Concurrent 2	Enterprise Data Strategy: Building a Data-Driven Culture	Amit Upadhyay
	Concurrent 3	Give Work to AI: How Agentic AI Powered the Humanless Swiss AI Chatbot Factory	Nick Gushchin
	Concurrent 4	AI-Powered ERP: Boosting Supply Chain Productivity and Cutting Costs at Scale	Abhijit Joshi
12:45 – 1:15 PM	Concurrent 1	Responsible by Design: Building Trustworthy AI from Data to Deployment	Sheena Yap Chan
	Concurrent 2	Scaling Knowledge Management with AI: From Enterprise Data Chaos to Intelligent Systems	Aakash Chaudhary
	Concurrent 3	From Prompts to Processes: Building Autonomous AI Workflows	Mihaela-Roxana Ghidersa
	Concurrent 4	Do AI Agents Know When to Stop? Fixing Over-Tooling and Under-Tooling in Production LLM Systems	Bhavuk Jain
1:15 – 1:45 PM	Concurrent 1	Modern Data Infrastructure Starts with Cloud Data Quality	Rajesh Kumar Kanji
	Concurrent 2	AI Governance at Scale: Building Trust Frameworks for Autonomous Enterprise AI	Harshit Kohli
	Concurrent 3	FinVerBench: Why LLMs Over-Flag Clean Financial Statements	Silu Panda
	Concurrent 4	Orchestrating AI Agents for Real-Time Customer Interactions	Madhavi Bonthu
1:45 – 2:15 PM	Concurrent 1	Why ML Deployments Fail in Production and How to Engineer Reliability at Scale	Ankur Gupta
	Concurrent 2	GRC-as-Code: Security Teams Can Ship AI Governance Without Slowing Engineering	Aakash Abhay
	Concurrent 3	Governed Memory Planes for Cloud AI Agents	Naveen Kumar Vedurupaka
	Concurrent 4	Why Analytics Maturity, Not Just AI Tools, Will Define Agentic AI Adoption in 2026	Arun Pratap Singh
2:15 – 2:45 PM	Plenary	**Fireside Chat with Industry Leaders**	

TIME (CST)	TYPE	SESSION	SPEAKER
2:45 – 3:15 PM	Concurrent 1	Leading Through Change: Guiding Enterprises into the AI-Powered Cloud Era	Shruti Dhumak
	Concurrent 2	Proving AI ROI in the Enterprise: Metrics That Survive the Boardroom	Deep Patel
	Concurrent 3	Using Agentic AI and LangChain for Patent Law Datasets	Thomas Plunkett
	Concurrent 4	Why Analytics Maturity, Not Just AI Tools, Will Define Agentic AI Adoption in 2026	Monisha Athi Premalatha
3:15 – 3:45 PM	Concurrent 1	Designing a Controlled LLM-Based Framework for Secure Database Operations	Bhargavi Vepuri
	Concurrent 2	Human-in-the-Loop AI: Leadership, Strategy, and Enterprise-Ready Decisioning	Su Belagodu
	Concurrent 3	From Single GPU to Production Clusters: Building Distributed AI Systems	Henry Fuheng Wu
	Concurrent 4	Beyond the Chatbot: The Era of Agentic and Multimodal AI	Supriya Raman
3:45 – 4:15 PM	Concurrent 1	Synthetic Lives for Smarter Agents: Generating Personal Context Data for AI Benchmark Design	Maitrik Patel
	Concurrent 2	Data Security in the Age of Autonomous AI: Strategies for Cybersecurity	Khadija Assbai
	Concurrent 3	The SCALER Framework: Closed-Loop Credential Governance for 1,000+ Database Accounts	Mayank Sethi
	Concurrent 4	Iceberg for Agents: Turning Lakehouse Data Into AI-Ready Context	Andrew Madson
4:15 – 4:45 PM	Concurrent 1	AI-Augmented Query Optimization: SQL Server 2025 Meets Fabric Self-Healing Data Platform	Karunakar Kotha
	Concurrent 2	Designing AI Agents Users Will Trust: Evals, Guardrails, and Feedback Loops	Cansu Berkem
	Concurrent 3	Hardware Roots of Trust for Secure AI and Data Platforms	Madhav Narayan Talapady
	Concurrent 4	Architecting Agentic Systems: Design Patterns for Production AI Agents	Maulik Bhatt
4:45 – 5:15 PM	Plenary	**Virtual Networking / Coffee Break**	
5:15 – 5:45 PM	Plenary	**Closing Keynote**	
5:45 – 6:00 PM	Plenary	**Closing Remarks – End of Day 1**	

Day 2 — Saturday, 21 November 2026

9:00 AM – 6:00 PM CST

TIME (CST)	TYPE	SESSION	SPEAKER
9:00 – 9:15 AM	Plenary	**Welcome & Announcements**	
9:15 – 9:45 AM	Plenary	**Opening Keynote Address**	
9:45 – 10:15 AM	Concurrent 1	Real-Time Data: Building Scalable and Sustainable Solutions	Aquayemi-Claude Akinsanya
	Concurrent 2	Both Sides of the Table: Leading AI Strategy While Getting Your Hands Dirty	Lydia Ray
	Concurrent 3	AI-Native Storytelling: Generative Tools Can Democratize Creativity	Hogan Shrum
	Concurrent 4	Explainable AI in Practice: From Model Output to Real-World Decisions	Harshal Goswam
10:15 – 10:45 AM	Concurrent 1	AI Co-pilots at Scale: Architecting a Multi-framework Agentic Platform	Virender Bhargav
	Concurrent 2	Beyond AI Demos: Embedding GenAI Into Product Workflows That Matter	Ashish Garg
	Concurrent 3	Your AI Knows Who's About to Quit. Should You Tell HR?	Gulce Guleli
	Concurrent 4	Data Observability Meets AI: Ensuring Trustworthy Intelligence at Scale	Rajesh Sura
10:45 – 11:15 AM	Concurrent 1	From Insights Agent to Executive Truth: Reinventing End-of-Campaign Intelligence	Abhijit Chanda
	Concurrent 2	From Models to Systems: How to Productionise Generative AI Across AWS and Azure	Raj Shekhar
	Concurrent 3	Who's Accountable When the Agent Acts? Governing Autonomous AI at Work	Kevin Barona
	Concurrent 4	The Agentic AI Revolution: Powered by Gemini on Google Cloud	Vijaykumar Jangamashetti
11:15 – 11:45 AM	Concurrent 1	Building Agentic AI Workflows with xAI on Vertex AI: From Code to Action	Mohamed Mortadha Manai
	Concurrent 2	Inclusive by Design: How Fintech and AI Are Powering Community-Driven Finance	Nikhil Kassetty
	Concurrent 3	What Does 'AI-First' Even Mean and Why Does Half Your Team Resist It?	Kateryna Motko
	Concurrent 4	Agentic Evaluation and Improvements on Freshness Quality in Large-Scale LLM RAG Systems	Susie Liu
11:45 AM – 12:15 PM	Plenary	**Virtual Networking / Coffee Break**	

TIME (CST)	TYPE	SESSION	SPEAKER
12:15 – 12:45 PM	Concurrent 1	From Shopping Carts to Autonomous Agents: How Agentic AI is Rewriting Retail	Durga Krishnamoorthy
	Concurrent 2	AI-Powered Digital Twins and Multi-Agent Intelligence for Enterprise Operations	Thiyagarajan Palaniyappan
	Concurrent 3	The Missing API Behind Great Tech Leadership	Amit Grinvald
	Concurrent 4	Generative AI for Scalable, Trustworthy Clinical Decision-Making	Santosh Kumar
12:45 – 1:15 PM	Concurrent 1	Multi-Agent Preventive Maintenance Diagnostics to Enhance Labor Productivity	Utkarsh Tripathi
	Concurrent 2	Secure RAG Architecture for Financial Institutions: Provenance and Policy Enforcement	Narendra Bhargav Boggarapu
	Concurrent 3	Quantum Machine Learning for AI-Driven Credit Risk Analytics	Bhaskara Reddy Udaru
	Concurrent 4	AI-Driven Autonomous Supply Chains: Replacing Human Planning Without Losing Control	Nirmal Jingar
1:15 – 1:45 PM	Concurrent 1	Streamlining AI Native Product Evals: LLM as Judge, Human in the Loop	Anil Pantangi
	Concurrent 2	The Agent Harness Beyond Code: Agentic Patterns for Use Cases Beyond Coding	Ishan Bhatt
	Concurrent 3	AI-Driven 5G Infrastructure Automation for Intelligent Data Ecosystems	Anil Kumar Thimmapuram
	Concurrent 4	Storytelling Is Becoming a Leadership Skill Again	Barbara Adwalpalker
1:45 – 2:15 PM	Concurrent 1	The Rise of Vibe-Coding: Empowering the Next Wave of Makers	Omar Soussa
	Concurrent 2	Reimagining Enterprise Go-to-Market in the Agentic Era	Pranjal Saxena
	Concurrent 3	GenAI-Driven Digital Transformation with Dynamic Models	Saurabh Garg
	Concurrent 4	Orchestrated AI Agents in Production: Build Self-Healing Platform Diagnostics	Sumit Bhasin
2:15 – 2:45 PM	Plenary	**Fireside Chat with Industry Leaders**	
2:45 – 3:15 PM	Concurrent 1	Governing AI-Generated Code: Balancing Innovation, Risk, and Accountability	Ashima Chakravarty
	Concurrent 2	AI FinOps: Making Production LLMs Affordable Without Cutting Quality	Anwar Khan
	Concurrent 3	AI Won’t Replace Creators, It Will Replace Creative Limitations	Dann Paniccia
	Concurrent 4	MCPs, CLIs, and Skills: Choosing the Right Tooling Layer for Agentic Development	Nikita Kothari

TIME (CST)	TYPE	SESSION	SPEAKER
3:15 – 3:45 PM	Concurrent 1	Productionizing LLMs: Architecture, Tradeoffs, and Hard Lessons from the Trenches	Kanish Manuja
	Concurrent 2	Ethics in the Agentic Loop: A Practical Guide to Responsible AI Agent Lifecycle	Vidura Wijekoon
	Concurrent 3	From Copilot to Co-worker: Building an AI Agent Strategy That Survives	Shankar Krishnan
	Concurrent 4	When SELECT WHERE id = 42 Reads the Entire Lake: Building a Bloom Filter Optimizer	Tanmay Rauth
3:45 – 4:15 PM	Concurrent 1	Beyond the AI Demo: How to Ship LLM Features That Actually Work in Production	Priyan Pattnayak
	Concurrent 2	Agentic RAG Tester: Generating Ranked Test Cases from Features and Prod Events	Akshay Aggarwal
	Concurrent 3	RAG in Production: Everything That Breaks After the Pilot	Kishore Arul
	Concurrent 4	Building Trust at Scale: Trusted AI Testing for Generative and Agentic AI Systems	Anant Somvanshi
4:15 – 4:45 PM	Concurrent 1	AI Archaeology: Transforming Retired Models into Strategic Intelligence	Ajitha Rathinam Buvanachandran
	Concurrent 2	Beyond Dashboards: The Rise of Conversational and Autonomous Analytics	Abeer Shrivastava
	Concurrent 3	Data-Pipeline Evals for Reliable AI Systems	Kunal Jain
	Concurrent 4	Beyond the Hype: Engineering Trustworthy AI Agents for the Real World	Tejas Patel
4:45 – 5:15 PM	Plenary	**Virtual Networking / Coffee Break**	
5:15 – 5:45 PM	Plenary	**Closing Keynote**	
5:45 – 6:00 PM	Plenary	**Closing Remarks – End of Day 2**	

Day 3 — Sunday, 22 November 2026

9:00 AM – 6:00 PM CST

TIME (CST)	TYPE	SESSION	SPEAKER
9:00 – 9:15 AM	Plenary	**Welcome & Announcements**	
9:15 – 9:45 AM	Plenary	**Opening Keynote Address**	
9:45 – 10:15 AM	Concurrent 1	Context Engineering: The Missing Layer Between AI Hype and Data Agents	David Effiong
	Concurrent 2	Build Your First Agent in Copilot Studio	Elayne Jones
	Concurrent 3	AI-Driven Industry 4.0 Transformation Through IoT, Cloud, and Intelligent Automation	Sudhakar Reddipalli
	Concurrent 4	AI Driven Predictive Analytics for Early Sepsis Detection and Intervention	Swapna Chimanchodkar
10:15 – 10:45 AM	Concurrent 1	S.T.E.P. Up Your Leadership Strategy with Data-Driven Insights	Dr. Joe Perez
	Concurrent 2	Revolutionizing Financial Services: AI-Driven Data Pipelines	Preeta Pillai
	Concurrent 3	The Human Side of AI: Curiosity and Credibility in a World Moving Faster	Alexandra Hartman
	Concurrent 4	Integrating Healthcare Guidelines with Governed GenAI	Anjan Chatterjee
10:45 – 11:15 AM	Concurrent 1	Revolutionizing Healthcare with AI	Madhvi Sharma
	Concurrent 2	Designing Governed AI-Ready Platforms for the Enterprise	Nishanth Sirikonda
	Concurrent 3	Build Once, Reuse Repeatedly: Turning Documents into AI-Powered Work Assets	Chinazor Vivian Kalu
	Concurrent 4	From Reactive to Predictive: Using Amazon Q and Generative AI to Transform Enterprise Cloud Support	Mayuri Dekate
11:15 – 11:45 AM	Concurrent 1	SmartSAN AI: AI-Driven Intelligent Framework for Autonomous Zero-Downtime SAN Migrations	Mahipal Reddy Yalla
	Concurrent 2	Turning Data into Intelligent Systems	Shishir Tewari
	Concurrent 3	Your AI Workflow Needs a Human Exit Ramp	Dr. Tajah M. Gross
	Concurrent 4	From Manual to Automated: Building a Real-Time AI-Driven Creative Enrichment Pipeline at Scale	Aneri Shah
11:45 AM – 12:15 PM	Plenary	**Virtual Networking / Coffee Break**	
12:15 – 12:45 PM	Concurrent 1	Designing AI-Native Enterprises: The Next Evolution of Enterprise Architecture	Dr. Gaurav Kumar Gupta
	Concurrent 2	Data Strategy for the AI Era: Embedding Authority into Execution	Dr. Hong Gui
	Concurrent 3	Modernizing Flood Risk Analysis with AI-Ready Hydrologic Data Pipelines	Edwin Ochieng
	Concurrent 4	Building Agent Harnesses to Match Frontier-Model Performance in RAG	Vineeth Kalluru

TIME (CST)	TYPE	SESSION	SPEAKER
12:45 – 1:15 PM	Concurrent 1	Enterprise Architecture Patterns for Production-Grade AI Systems	Saad Sheikh
	Concurrent 2	AI-Powered Governance: The Future of Salesforce Automation in Pharma	Sri Charan Reddy Pennaka
	Concurrent 3	Guardrails Across the Stack: Directing AI Through a POS System	Menahil Tanveer
	Concurrent 4	The Analytics Engineer in the Era of AI Agents	Fabiyi Opeyemi
1:15 – 1:45 PM	Concurrent 1	Building Cloud-Native AI Ready Financial Platforms with Security and Resilience	Nagarjuna Gummadi
	Concurrent 2	Specification-Anchored Detection of Design System Drift Using Vision and Multimodal LLMs	Jai Chandra Mouli Langoju
	Concurrent 3	Agentic AI for Autonomous Network Operations: Advancing CSP Autonomy	Gopinathan Thirugnanam
	Concurrent 4	RAG Under Attack: Securing Enterprise AI Against Prompt Injection and Data Leakage	Bhargavi Kalicheti
1:45 – 2:15 PM	Concurrent 1	LLM-Assisted Auto-Generation of Enterprise ETL Pipelines from Metadata	Pavan Kumar Kodati
	Concurrent 2	Transforming Modern Data Engineering with Generative AI in Databricks	Kushal Vishwakarma
	Concurrent 3	From Legacy to Intelligence: How AI Is Rewriting Software for the Next Decade	Sandeep Voona
	Concurrent 4	Production-Grade AI Infrastructure for Defense: Scaling Vision-Language Models Securely	Niyati P
2:15 – 2:45 PM	Plenary	**Fireside Chat with Industry Leaders**	
2:45 – 3:15 PM	Concurrent 1	LLMs Meet Classical Algorithms: A Hybrid Approach for Large-Scale Optimization	Ravi Teja Pagidoju
	Concurrent 2	Building AI Agents That Corp Finance Actually Trust	Shikha Gupta
	Concurrent 3	Automate Your Tasks by Building Agentic AI	Suprajyotsna Dasari
	Concurrent 4	Human-AI Collaboration for FWA: Smarter Network Ops and Retention	Venkata Raghavendra Vaishnav Vinjamuri
3:15 – 3:45 PM	Concurrent 1	Mastering Multi-Cloud ERP Integration: Data Normalization and Synchronization	Srinivasan Pakkirisamy
	Concurrent 2	Building an ISO 42001 Compliant AI Center of Excellence in Big Tech	Shabir Mustehsan
	Concurrent 3	Agentic Governance: Securing Autonomous AI Systems at Enterprise Scale	Rama Krishna Raju Samantapudi
	Concurrent 4	Leveraging AI for Data-Driven Documentation: Capturing and Scaling Domain Knowledge	Ayoade Adegbite

TIME (CST)	TYPE	SESSION	SPEAKER
3:45 – 4:15 PM	Concurrent 1	Building AI-Ready Database Foundations for Enterprise LLMs	Chandrashekhar Rao
	Concurrent 2	AI-Driven Cloud Defense: Fortifying National Infrastructure Against Cyber Threats	TBC
	Concurrent 3	Accessible and Inclusive AI Systems: Lessons from a Real-World Multimodal AI Platform	Vinod Ramachandran
	Concurrent 4	The AI in SharePoint Knowledge Agent Is Out: What Does That Mean for Your Organization?	Knut Relbe-Moe
4:15 – 4:45 PM	Concurrent 1	From Code to Strategy	Manushi Sheth
	Concurrent 2	Designing AI-Native Enterprises: The Next Evolution	TBC
	Concurrent 3	The Human Side of AI: Leading with Curiosity and Credibility	TBC
	Concurrent 4	Engineering Beyond the Rule of Eight	Harsh Ranjan
	Concurrent 5	Multimodal AI: Unifying Data for Context-Aware Intelligence	Selvan Subramanian
	Concurrent 6	Building Trustworthy and Inclusive AI Systems: Lessons from a Real-World Multimodal AI Platform	Utpal Das
	Concurrent 7	The Human Side of AI: Curiosity and Credibility in a World Moving Faster Than Understanding	Alexandra Allie Hartman
	Concurrent 8	What Does AI-First Even Mean and Why Does Half Your Team Resist It?	Kateryna Kate Motko
	Concurrent 9	Human Leadership in the Age of Intelligent Agents	Isaac Agya Koomson
4:45 – 5:15 PM	Plenary	**Virtual Networking / Coffee Break**	
5:15 – 5:45 PM	Plenary	**Closing Keynote**	
5:45 – 6:00 PM	Plenary	**Closing Remarks – End of Conference**	